

Phishing Awareness Analysis

Submitted By:

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Organization:

DecodeLabs

Introduction:

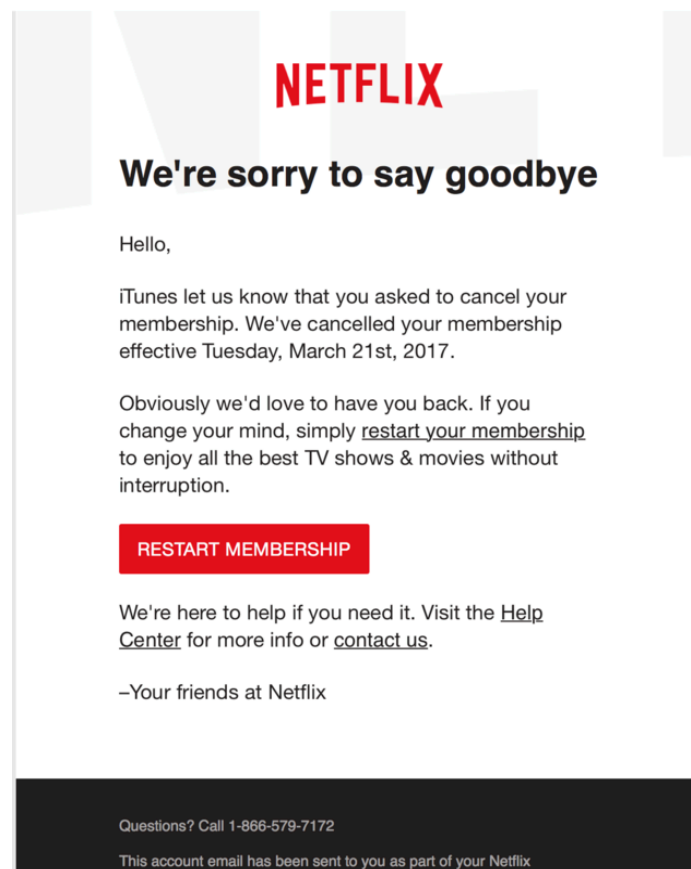
Phishing is a cyberattack in which hackers try to act like a trusted organization or individual to trick victims by sending them malicious email, or links to trust them and give their sensitive information such as credit card details, passwords or any kind of login credentials as well. It is the most frequent and common cyberattack that people are dealing with on a daily basis.

Project Objective:

The purpose of this project is to:

- Identify phishing emails and messages.
- Detect suspicious links and sender information.
- Analyze phishing red flags.
- Understand social engineering techniques.
- Recommend appropriate security actions.

Sample 1:



Red Flags:

1. A fear trigger at first and no polite behavior does not seem like customer service or help center tone.
2. A huge button that says “RESTART MEMBERSHIP” in capital, another red flag sounds more like a hurry or emergency. Attackers often use capital words to increase click and gather attention.
3. At the end it says “Your Friends at Netflix”, Netflix or any other well known official and websites would never say something informal like this.
4. Link or url can be suspicious if it does not redirect to Netflix official website.

Why it is Unsafe:

Hackers often try to impersonate streaming services to steal sensitive information such as login credentials or credit card details. Users may click the button in fear and hurry without reading it properly and no link to the destination website.

Risk Severity:

Medium

Sample 2:

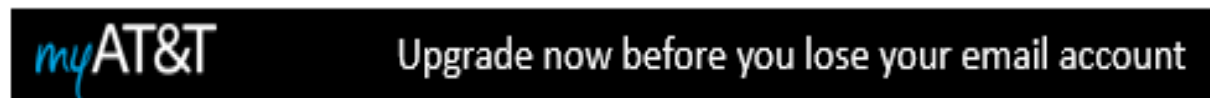
-----Forwarded Message-----

From: myAt&t ddt34@fhgvh876.com

To: "att-services.123085063@att-mail.com" att-services.123085063@att-mail.com

Sent: Saturday, August 1, 2020, 7:08:50 AM EDT

Subject: Upgrade Now



The Classic version of your Mail will be replaced by our new version on the 3rd of August 2020. So it's time to upgrade before you lose your email access.

[UPGRADE NOW](#)

Protecting your information is important to us and we work continuously to strengthen the threats targeting our Financial Institution.

Thanks for choosing us,
AT&T

Red Flags:

1. Suspicious email and domain name. Instead of using a random email address AT&T would use their official email. Attackers mostly try to use similar words to make it look legitimate and trick users.
2. The subject line is very vague and email is asking for upgrading or you will lose your email address sound more like a threat and can create panic in customers.
3. Suspicious url that says "UPGRADE NOW" should rather smth like AT&T official website or portal link instead of upgrade button.
4. Email is very generic, it is not targeting specific individual by saying their name

Why it is Unsafe:

The attacker is faking himself into AT&T customer service and gathering user sensitive information by this fake mail and url.

Risk Severity:

High